

The New Nature - The Light of Men

Open to John 9, please, where we left off. Then, of course, we will go back to John 1. We have been studying on the Born-Again Trail. We will pass in review briefly and then pick it up again in John 9:1.

In the first session, we found out from Romans that sin will not have dominion over you because you are not under the law, but under grace. For a believer to really walk in victory, the first transformation we have to have is to that fact. I mean totally transformed to the fact that sin does not have dominion over us.

Everything we have been set free from, if we continue to justify it, then we have taken away from the Holy Spirit what He needs to set us free with.

So to really walk this Born-Again Trail out, the first transformation is this: sin no longer has dominion over me. All the cohorts or byproducts of sin, such as poverty, sickness, disease, depression, and all the things that accompany spiritual death, do not have dominion over me either. If sin does not have dominion over me, neither do these other things.

The first thing the Holy Spirit is going to do in your life using that new nature is transform you to the fact that none of these things have dominion over you.

I am not saying this to bring you under condemnation. I am saying it to set you free. If I am willing to justify something and say, "It was stronger than I was," then I have not given the Holy Spirit all He needs to set me free. It was not stronger than you. The disease does not have more power than you have. Nothing has more power than you do.

Even if you were defeated by things, this is not meant to bring you under condemnation, but rather to eventually ensure your success.

Hallelujah.

Romans says:

"If ye through the Spirit do mortify the deeds of the body, ye shall live.
For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God."

That word "sons of God" denotes a maturity where the flesh does not rule you, but you rule out of the new nature that has been put in your spirit. He is saying that as many as are led by the Spirit of God are sons of God. The Holy Ghost is able to lead you out of that new nature, and you become a mature son whom the flesh rules over no more.

It is through the Spirit that you mortify the deeds of the body. As many as will accept His leadership, He will lead them out of a walk dominated by the flesh. Because you are a son of God, sin will not have dominion over you. It absolutely will not.

The first order of the leadership of the Spirit in our life is to lead us out of everything Jesus said we are free from and into everything He said we could be.

My first order of transformation in taking His leadership is that I have to know that I know. It has to be settled on the inside of me for good: because sin does not have dominion over me, neither does anything connected with it. Nothing. It does not have dominion.

When I transform to that fact, that is when I will really begin to walk out of those things.

We began to differentiate between the two births: your first birth, which is born of flesh, and your second birth, when you were born of spirit.

Your first birth is when your human spirit actually came into existence. Your second birth is when you were born again. Jesus told Nicodemus, "You must be born again." Your second birth is the same thing as being born from above.

Jesus said:

"That which is born of the flesh is flesh; and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit."

In my second birth, I was born again, or as the Greek says, born from above, just like Jesus was born from above when the Holy Spirit overshadowed Mary.

Peter said we were born of incorruptible seed by the Word of God, which abides forever. The word for seed is *spora*, a root word connected with sperm. It means my spirit was impregnated with the incorruptible seed of God. I was adopted by Him when I received His nature and literally received the power to become a son of God.

That was my second birth.

My first birth was of flesh. Human beings were producing human beings. Flesh produced flesh, and through that birth my human spirit first came into existence.

My second birth was when I became a son of God. Hallelujah.

I do not mind being a son of God. The more I tap into that, the freer I get. In fact, I am getting so free I can hardly stand it. I do not even mind staying here among all this corruption because it is all subject to change. Why should I mind staying here when every day more and more of heaven comes to stay here with me?

Hallelujah.

More peace keeps raining out of that sonship and new nature He gave me. It gets so good I can hardly stand it. Somebody is going to have to pray for me.

Someone says, "Do you not understand everything going on around you?"

I understand it thoroughly, but it does not keep it from getting better and better. I look with sympathy, maybe empathy, when people fly apart in front of me. I think, Do they not know?

They say, "I am going to die." I want to open them up, put this inside them, and say, "Can you not see what you are?"

When you start letting the Holy Ghost bring forward what He made you in the rebirth, nothing in this world has the power to stop the path you take all the way into God. Why? Because you have finally handed over to the Holy Spirit what He needs to give you your full inheritance.

When I was born of incorruptible seed, when I was born of God, I received all the inheritance of heaven that moment. When I turn myself over to the Holy Ghost, He says, "I have come to see to it that you inherit."

And I say, "I have learned the Word of God to make sure You can see to it."

Hallelujah.

I had a first birth. I was born of flesh. When I was born of flesh, that little spirit came into existence on the inside of me. At the moment of impregnation, that tiny spirit was only one cell old, but it grew at the same rate my body did to fill this body all in all.

Now, I know we may run into some doctrinal confusion here, but that is why we have our early class.

Somebody says, "God is creating those little spirits in heaven."

No, He is not. Those tiny spirits come into existence at the moment of procreation. At that moment, the little spirit comes into existence and grows at the same rate as the body.

If you abort and cut that little body out, you are not going to cut that little spirit out. That little spirit is born in a state of innocence. Sin is not imputed to it. So in our covenant, the moment you cut it out, God gives it a new nature and takes it home to be with Him.

People say, "God created that little spirit in heaven."

Why would He do that? Create that little spirit in heaven, send it to earth just to be cut out, and then take it back to heaven? Do you mean He creates little spirits in heaven and sends them to earth so they can grow up and go to hell?

The early world was terminated. God brought it back down to one family so that one family would have the knowledge of God and start over again. That was an act of mercy because all flesh had gone its own way except that one family. Every child being born was growing up with all flesh going Satan's way and being sent to hell. It was mercy that God brought it back down to one family so the whole earth could be full of the knowledge of God again.

Our little spirits are not created in heaven. They come into existence through the law of Genesis. God told Adam, "Be fruitful, multiply, and replenish the earth." He established the law of Genesis.

No other creature has that same power to procreate an eternal creature. God oversaw the creation of every angel. But with you and me, it is through procreation. God gave us that power, flesh bringing forth flesh, to bring forth an eternal creature.

Think about it. Sinners have that power. The whole world has that power. That is why John said:

"Which were born, not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God."

The whole world has the power to bring forth eternal creatures. Angels cannot do it. Every time God brings forth an angel, He presides over its creation. But when you and I procreate, we bring forth an eternal creature who is going to live forever somewhere.

Thank God it is my covenant right to believe for a child before that child is born. But the world does not have that right. They procreate like crazy. They bring little eternal creatures into the world, and those children grow past accountability and go to hell by the millions.

Gary said, "I know what you are saying is true, but I am a teacher. Because I am a teacher, I have to have a lot of ammunition. When you make a statement like that, you have to have a lot of ammunition to back it up."

You should have heard what God told him to settle it.

Gary said:

"Turn to Luke 3. I was asking the Lord, 'I need something concrete,' because I had never really heard anything like this until I heard Dave. It made sense to me, and I believed it, but I needed more ammunition.

I was praying about this, praying in the Holy Spirit, praying in other tongues. The begats kept floating up in my spirit, so I went and read them. Matthew's account is good, but Luke's account really cemented it for me.

Luke 3:38 says:

'Which was the son of Enos, which was the son of Seth, which was the son of Adam, which was the son of God.'

In the beginning we start with the Son of God. But notice Adam's son Seth is not called the son of God. He is called the son of Adam. Enos is not called the son of God. He is called the son of Seth. And all the way down, there is only one other called the Son of God, and that is the Lord Jesus Christ.

The first man Adam and the second Man, the last Adam, Jesus Christ. All the ones in between are not called the son of God. The first Adam was called the son of God, and the last Adam was called the Son of God. When you are born again, I do not know which number you were, but you are also called a son or daughter of God because you are born from above."

Those little spirits come into existence through procreation.

People say, "Satan has no redemption."

That is correct, because he had no tempter. But I always wondered about the third of the angels who followed him. How would you like to hear the message he preached to those angels that caused them to follow him?

If those angels are lost, I used to think, Wait a minute, God. If Satan had no tempter, and that third of the angels did have a tempter, why do they not have redemption?

The difference between them and you is this: Adam had a tempter. But as far as you are concerned, you were born of flesh. Romans says by the transgression of one man, Adam, sin entered into the world and death by sin, and so death passed upon all men, for all have sinned.

The whole human race inherited spiritual death from the first man Adam. You did not ask to be born. You did not ask to be born in the lost state of a fallen race. You were born as the product of the will of man. All of a sudden, you were here.

You did not ask to be brought into this world in an unregenerated, lost state. That is why Jesus came and provided salvation for you.

But the angels were not procreated by a lost race. God oversaw the creation of each angel. He created them Himself. That is why they have no Redeemer.

You were born in this state. That is why Jesus came to make sure you had the opportunity for a second birth, to be born from above and reclaim your original state as a son or daughter of God.

Oh, I have His nature. I have been born from above.

Hallelujah.

Let us prove our point a little deeper. In John 9:1-2:

"And as Jesus passed by, he saw a man which was blind from his birth.

And his disciples asked him, saying, Master, who did sin, this man, or his parents, that he was born blind?"

What kind of question is that? When did he sin, in his mother's womb? What did he do, kick her in the heart? How could he sin in the womb?

They asked, "Who did sin, this man or his parents, that he was born blind?"

Jesus answered:

"Neither hath this man sinned, nor his parents: but that the works of God should be made manifest in him."

If this is the case, if it was not him or his parents, then why? This man was connected with the covenant. He had an Old Testament covenant. So if it was not this man's fault or his parents' fault, then why was he born blind?

That is the same kind of question they asked Jesus about the Galileans whose blood Pilate mixed with their sacrifices. They asked whether those men were greater sinners than others. Jesus said no.

Then they asked about the tower in Siloam that fell and killed eighteen people. One situation was murder, the other was an accident. Jesus said those eighteen did not die accidentally because they were greater sinners than others in Siloam. He said the reason one man perishes and another does not is not because one is a greater sinner. Eventually, you are all going to perish.

Then why?

He gave the parable of the fruitless fig tree to tell them why. A man had a fruitless fig tree in his vineyard. The tree resisted all efforts of prayer, cultivation, and discipline. Finally, the destroyer stepped up and said, "Cut it down. Why cumbereth it the ground?"

Then the vinedresser stepped between the destruction and the tree and said, "Leave it alone. Let me work with it."

That was an intercessor.

The reason one man perishes and one does not is because the one who perished had no intercessor. That is the only reason.

One of the most important services the prayer center has is naming your lost loved ones and calling them saved, and many do not even know it.

Now we are facing something difficult. The disciples are asking, "Why was this man born blind and this one was not?"

Now that I know my covenant and how to operate it, I know how many more children in my family will be born. I have inherited rights to employ in every area, and my seed will be blessed even before they are born. But that is not the case in random procreation, where the world and every culture are giving birth to flesh and eternal little spirits are coming into existence through procreation.

When that little spirit comes into existence at the birth of random flesh, the question remains: why was this man born blind? Was it him? How could it be him? Was it his parents?

Not his immediate parents. It was the first man Adam and Eve. Because of their transgression, sin entered the world and death by sin, and in that all have sinned. We inherited spiritual death. The whole human race inherited it.

That is why Jesus is called the Firstborn of many brethren. He was not the first to be resurrected naturally from the dead. Elisha raised the dead. Jesus raised the dead. He just took their spirits out of Abraham's bosom, put them back into their bodies, and put them on the surface of the earth.

That was not the birth He was talking about when Jesus was called the Firstborn from the dead. Jesus was born spiritually alive, then died spiritually, and you and I were baptized into His death. We were already spiritually dead. Jesus became spiritually dead, and God said, "If you want to be saved, come over where He died and be baptized into His death so you can be resurrected out of that death with Him and be born again."

I was quickened together with Him.

Hallelujah.

Jesus said, "I came not to condemn the world, but that the world through Me might be saved." He said the world was condemned already. He identified with me in spiritual death so I could be baptized into His death and come out with Him in His resurrection when God raised Him from the dead.

In that one died, we were all dead. God is waiting for you to accept what He did. When you do, He resurrects you with Him, quickens you together with Him, births you, makes a new creation out of you, gives you the power to become a son of God, gives you His nature, adopts you into His family, and immediately gives you an inheritance to be brought to pass by the power of the Holy Spirit.

This man was born blind not because of his sin or his parents' immediate sin, but because he was offspring of a spiritually dead race.

You hear people say all the time, "God gave this person such a precious gift. He should use it for God." That is correct. But who gave the Down syndrome child his gift? Who gave the child born without arms or legs his gift? Who gave a baby born without a face his gift?

In your first birth, you were not born equal unless your parents had a covenant with God and laid hold of you before birth. Buddhists, Muslims, and random flesh all produce flesh. The first creation of that tiny spirit happens through procreation.

The human race is not born equal. You could have been born without a face. You could have been born without an arm. Mercy ships go over and reconstruct mouths and noses for babies born with holes in their faces where their nose and mouth should have been. You could have been born like that, but you were not.

The first birth was not equal.

In your second birth, you became a son of God with no respect of persons. All of us have the same inheritance on the inside of us.

Jesus told the Jews, "The servant abideth not in the house for ever: but the Son abideth ever." They said, "We are Abraham's seed and were never in bondage to any man." Jesus said, "He that commits sin is the servant of sin." The servant will not abide in the household of the Father forever, but the son abides forever.

When you are born again, you become a son and will abide in the house of God forever. You have received your inheritance now, and the Holy Ghost is the earnest of your inheritance. He is the power, the down payment of heaven, to ensure that everything you have a right to, you will receive.

If you do not have an arm and have the courage to believe for it, you can receive an arm, because in the second birth you have every right to everything God has for you.

Again, John 9:1-3 says:

"And as Jesus passed by, he saw a man which was blind from his birth.

And his disciples asked him, saying, Master, who did sin, this man, or his parents, that he was born blind?

Jesus answered, Neither hath this man sinned, nor his parents: but that the works of God should be made manifest in him."

You know what the religious mind has done with that verse. It says God made this man blind, and he suffered his whole life just so one day Jesus would walk by and heal him.

If you believe that about God, your revelation knowledge is going to be highly limited. It may appear to say that, but until you quit believing ugly things about God, He is not going to tell you anything different.

If you talked about my wife and family the way some of you talk about Him, I would take you out behind the church and whip you. My wife would not inoculate you with disease, and neither would He.

So what is Jesus saying?

Read it this way. At the end of "parents," put a period. Stop there. That is the end of the thought:

"Neither hath this man sinned, nor his parents."

Then the second half of verse 3 belongs with verse 4:

"But that the works of God should be made manifest in him, I must work the works of him that sent me, while it is day: the night cometh, when no man can work."

Then Jesus stepped up and gave the man his sight to show what the works of God were, not the darkness.

Hallelujah. That is my Father.

Let us explore this rebirth a little deeper. Go to John 1:1.

Here is a little verse I passed over for twenty-three or twenty-four years because it did not really mean anything to me. I could only generalize it. Yet this little verse has given me more victory than I can even talk about, because I cannot yet describe what has happened to me.

John 1:1 says:

"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God."

"In the beginning" means before anything had a beginning that you and I understand to exist: before planets, before outer space, before anything. We know God existed before anything had a beginning because He is where everything came from.

Before anything had a beginning was the Logos, the Word, whom you and I now understand as Jesus, because the Word became flesh, was glorified, and went back to sit at the right hand of the Father. He is as much God as He is glorified Man. He is the second Person in the Godhead.

Before anything had a beginning, He was known as the Logos, the Word. The whole Godhead existed forever before anything had any beginning. That is the time John is referring to.

Notice that John separates the Word from Jehovah, the second Person of the Godhead from the first Person, right in this first verse:

"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God."

The Logos stood face to face, eyes to eyes, coequal and tri-equal in every aspect with the other two members of the Godhead. That describes our Jesus in eternity past.

A son has to have a beginning. The humanity of Jesus had a beginning, but the deity of Jesus always was.

An anthropomorphism is a characteristic God assigns to Himself so we can understand Him. Father is an anthropomorphism. We understand fatherhood because we have natural fathers. Son is an anthropomorphism. We understand sonship. But the Holy Spirit is not an anthropomorphism. He has always existed as what He is and will ever be.

God only took those roles for creation and for our understanding. Mighty Jehovah planned everything. The mighty Logos created everything. The mighty Holy Spirit has always been involved in regenerating and sustaining everything.

John 1:3 says:

"All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made."

Not one single thing was made without Him.

If you want more proof, John 1:10 says:

"He was in the world, and the world was made by him, and the world knew him not."

The Logos was in the world, the world was made by Him, and the world knew Him not.

John 1:4 is the verse I am talking about:

"In him was life; and the life was the light of men."

In Him was life, and that life was the light of men.

Between verses 3 and 4, John switches from deity only to deity and humanity. In verse 4, He becomes the Jesus we know. He was born of a virgin, born of the Holy Spirit, and grew up. In that state, John says:

"In him was life."

What life was in Him? Whatever that life was, it became my light.

That life was the life placed in Him by God. Jesus was the first Man in His spirit since Adam to be born spiritually alive. That was the life in Him that became your light and my light.

When you and I were born again, the same kind of spiritually alive human spirit that was in Him became the light of men in us. We received a nature that could understand God. Therefore God could reveal Himself to us.

The life in Him, a spiritually alive human spirit, became my light because at last I could know God and be taught by God.

Go to First John 1:1-2:

"That which was from the beginning, which we have heard, which we have seen with our eyes, which we have looked upon, and our hands have handled, of the Word of life; For the life was manifested, and we have seen it, and bear witness, and show unto you that eternal life, which was with the Father, and was manifested unto us."

What life? The life of the first human being since the first man Adam to be born spiritually alive. When that life was placed in me, it became my light. At last I could understand God.

That is what Corinthians was talking about when it said:

"Now we have received, not the spirit of the world, but the spirit which is of God; that we might know the things that are freely given to us of God."

You did not receive the spirit of this world, inherited from Adam and spiritually dead. You received the spirit that is of God, a born-again spirit, so that you might at last know the things freely given to you by God because you have His nature.

That life that was in Him is in me, and it is my light. I can understand God.

That is why He sent me the Holy Spirit to teach me all about Him, because I am ready.

Unless we understand our covenant as born-again, Holy Ghost-filled believers, we will never really understand meditation. In our covenant, our primary Teacher is the Holy Spirit. He is the One given to us to guide us into all truth. Where man leaves off, He picks up and gives us what no man can give us.

Our covenant is different from the covenant God gave the Old Testament saints. They were not born again as you and I understand being born again. It was impossible for the Holy Spirit to fulfill His ministry in them as He does in us because their spirits were not capable of understanding light, nor did they have a new nature that made it possible for the Holy Ghost to dwell in them.

That is why Jesus said what He did while giving His disciples their final instructions before He was taken away:

"And I will pray the Father, and he shall give you another Comforter, that he may abide with you for ever;

Even the Spirit of truth; whom the world cannot receive, because it seeth him not, neither knoweth him:

but ye know him; for he dwelleth with you, and shall be in you."

The Old Testament saints were men and women waiting for the promise of the cross to be fulfilled in them, when God would come, take away their old nature, and give them a new one that freed them from sin.

For thousands of years they lived, died, and went to a place called Abraham's bosom, an Old Testament type of heaven, and waited. It was a very comfortable place God provided for them while they waited out the dispensations leading up to the cross, when God would give them a new nature, free them from sin, and finally make it possible for them to leave the shadows and types of the Old Covenant behind, including Abraham's bosom, and go into heaven itself, into the presence of God.

Luke 16:22 briefly mentions this place:

"And it came to pass, that the beggar died, and was carried by the angels into Abraham's bosom."

Abraham's bosom was the place of those who embraced the promise God made to Abraham, that in his Seed, Christ, all nations of the earth would be blessed. Anyone who died resting in that promise waited in Abraham's bosom until the waiting period was over and the Old Testament saints could be born again, receive a new nature, and dwell in the presence of God again.

That had not happened since the fall of Adam and the spiritual death of the human race.

But this is not so in our case, Tim. We are not born under the Old Covenant. We are born under the New. When we embrace salvation, unlike Old Testament saints who had to wait for the change of covenants to be born again, God immediately gives us a new nature. When we die, because we have a new nature, there is no waiting period for us. We are ushered into the presence of God, into heaven itself.

Hebrews 11:39-40 says:

"And these all, having obtained a good report through faith, received not the promise: God having provided some better thing for us, that they without us should not be made perfect."

They had to wait for the birth.

Think about our covenant. We live in the dispensation when God's redemption plan is able to impart the born-again experience to our spirit. In the creation of our new nature, He has so thoroughly cleansed us from our sins that we are now able to receive His Holy Spirit.

So pure and guiltless have we become in the sight of God in our new natures that God is able to send the Holy Spirit in all His holiness and pureness to live inside us, move into our new natures, and become to us what no man can give us: the Instructor of our new nature and the Wisdom of our understanding.

In our covenant, the Holy Spirit is our primary Teacher. Upon our invitation, He is ready to take up His ministry inside us and guide us into all truth. When all the pastors have done what they are supposed to do, when all the teachers have taught what they are supposed to teach, when all the instructors have instructed and the exhorters exhorted, He is the One who gives you what no man can give you.

He is the Minister of your understanding and the Instructor of your new nature.

Many Christians do not understand the ministry of the Holy Spirit toward us as our Teacher. When we were born again, we received a new nature that could understand spiritual things, but in reality, we still had to be taught.

Let me say that again. When we were born again, we received a new nature that could understand spiritual things, but we still had to be taught.

You are still a separate individual from the Holy Spirit. He is one Person, and you are another. You do not automatically know everything He knows because you received the baptism of the Holy Spirit. But now you can be taught.

The same way one person transfers knowledge to another, the Holy Spirit must transfer His knowledge to you through guiding and teaching. That is why Jesus said:

"Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth:
for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak:
and he will show you things to come."

When He comes into our new nature through baptism, He comes to teach us and guide us into all truth. In much the same way you enter a classroom and a teacher teaches you what he knows by transferring his knowledge to you, the Holy Spirit teaches you.

When you entered the classroom, you did not automatically know everything the teacher knew. It had to be taught to you.